



THE STREET HEBREW SURVIVAL GUIDE

50 Essential Phrases to Navigate the Israeli Street with 100% Confidence —
Zero Grammar Inside.

"I spent weeks in Ulpan learning how to write essays, but froze when the Wolt delivery guy called. I created this guide so you don't have to experience that 'street paralysis'. Here is the exact script you need to sound like a local."



Public Spaces & Bureaucracy

Survive any clerk, landlord, or government counter.

סליחה, אפשר לעזור לי?	<i>Slee-cha, ef-shar la-a-ZOR li?</i>	Excuse me, can you help me? (polite opener — works everywhere)
יש לי בעיה עם החשמל.	<i>Yesh li be-a-YA im ha-CHASH-mal.</i>	I have a problem with the electricity. (landlord's cue to panic)
מתי אפשר לתקן?	<i>Ma-TAI ef-shar le-ta-KEN?</i>	When can it be fixed? (the follow-up that actually gets results)
יש לי תור ב-9.	<i>Yesh li TOR be-TEI-sha.</i>	I have an appointment at 9. (skips the line, trust me)
צריך לשלם ארנונה.	<i>Tzar-ICH li-sh-LEM ar-NO-na.</i>	Need to pay municipal tax. (say it confidently, they'll respect that)
אפשר לקבל קבלה?	<i>Ef-SHAR le-ka-BEL ka-ba-LA?</i>	Can I get a receipt? (essential for any Israeli transaction)
הלינק לא עובד.	<i>Ha-LINK lo o-VED.</i>	The link doesn't work. (universal Israeli tech complaint)
יש טופס למלא?	<i>Yesh TOH-fes le-ma-LE?</i>	Is there a form to fill? (shows you know the drill)
אני חדש פה.	<i>A-NI cha-DASH po.</i>	I'm new here. (magic phrase — unlocks extra patience from any clerk)
תודה רבה, עזרת לי מאוד.	<i>To-DA ra-BA, a-ZAR-ta li me-OD.</i>	Thank you so much, you helped me a lot. (ends any interaction on a high note)



Cafes & Restaurants

Order, sip, and pay like a Tel Aviv regular.

קפה הפוך, בבקשה.	<i>Ka-FE ha-FUCH, be-va-ka-SHA.</i>	Upside-down coffee (Israeli latte). The national drink. Order this, belong.
בלי סוכר.	<i>Be-LI su-KAR.</i>	Without sugar. (they'll add it anyway — say this twice)
עם חלב בצד.	<i>Im cha-LAV ba-TZAD.</i>	Milk on the side. (sounds very Israeli, very intentional)
מה הסגנון?	<i>Ma ha-sig-NON?</i>	What's the vibe? (asked before choosing a cafe — instant local cred)
אפשר מים?	<i>Ef-SHAR ma-YIM?</i>	Can I have water? (free, always — but you have to ask)
זה טעים מאוד!	<i>Ze ta-IM me-OD!</i>	This is delicious! (say it loud — the owner is always nearby)
יש ויתר בלי גלוטן?	<i>Ve-i-TER be-LI glu-TEN?</i>	Is there a gluten-free option? (Tel Aviv is very gluten-aware)
חשבון, בבקשה.	<i>Chesh-BON, be-va-ka-SHA.</i>	Check, please. (wave your hand once — no need to chase the waiter)
ביחד או נפרד?	<i>Be-ya-CHAD o nif-RAD?</i>	Together or separate? (they'll ask — now you know what it means)
לקחת.	<i>La-KA-chat.</i>	To-go. (one word, zero confusion)



Markets & Money

Bargain at the shuk and walk out with the win.

כמה זה עולה?	<i>Ka-MA ze O-le?</i>	How much does it cost? (ask before touching anything at Mahane Yehuda)
זה יקר מדי.	<i>Ze ya-KAR mi-DAI.</i>	That's too expensive. (say it, pause, look away — watch the price drop)
אפשר קצת יותר בזול?	<i>Ef-SHAR ktsat yo-TER be-ZOL?</i>	Can it be a bit cheaper? (the golden negotiation phrase)
אקח שניים.	<i>E-KACH shna-YIM.</i>	I'll take two. (the magic number that always gets a discount)
בכרטיס אשראי.	<i>Be-kar-TIS ash-RAI.</i>	By credit card. (they'll try to convince you cash is better — hold firm)
קבלה, בבקשה.	<i>Ka-ba-LA, be-va-ka-SHA.</i>	Receipt, please. (non-negotiable, always ask)
יש מבצע?	<i>Yesh miv-TZA?</i>	Is there a sale/deal? (the Israeli national question)
אפשר לטעום?	<i>Ef-SHAR lit-OM?</i>	Can I taste? (at markets, always yes — just ask)
זה טרי?	<i>Ze ta-RI?</i>	Is this fresh? (for anything at the market — they respect the question)
סגרנו עסקה.	<i>Sa-GAR-nu is-KA.</i>	We've got a deal. (seals the negotiation — very Israeli energy)



Small Talk & Networking

Slip into any conversation and sound like an insider.

מה נשמע?	<i>Ma nish-MA?</i>	What's up? (the Israeli 'hello' — use it constantly)
הכל בסדר?	<i>Ha-KOL be-SE-der?</i>	Is everything okay? (warm check-in, very common)
אח שלי!	<i>ACH she-LI!</i>	My brother! (term of endearment — used between strangers, means you're in)
סבבה גמור.	<i>Sa-BA-ba ga-MUR.</i>	Totally cool / all good. (highest level of Israeli approval)
תכלס, מה המצב?	<i>Tach-LES, ma ha-ma-TZAV?</i>	Real talk — what's the situation? (skips small talk, gets to business)
מאיפה אתה?	<i>Me-EI-fo a-TA?</i>	Where are you from? (they WILL ask within 30 seconds)
אני לומד עברית.	<i>A-NI lo-MED iv-RIT.</i>	I'm learning Hebrew. (instant goodwill — they'll want to help you)
יאללה, ביי!	<i>Ya-LA, bai!</i>	Yalla, bye! (the Israeli goodbye — iconic, use it)
חבל על הזמן, זה מדהים.	<i>Cha-VAL al ha-ZMAN, ze mad-HIM.</i>	What a waste of time — it's amazing! (sounds negative, means amazing)
נדבר.	<i>Ne-da-BER.</i>	We'll talk. (ends any conversation like a boss)



Emergency & Logistics

The phrases that save the day — and the delivery.

עזרה!	<i>ez-RA!</i>	Help! (short, loud, universal)
אני לא מבין/ה.	<i>A-NI lo me-VIN / me-VI-na.</i>	I don't understand. (say it early, before you nod and regret)
אפשר לדבר לאט?	<i>Ef-SHAR le-da-BER le-AT?</i>	Can you speak slowly? (they'll slow down — Israelis are impatient but kind)
אני מחכה למשלוח.	<i>A-NI me-cha-KE le-mish-LO-ach.</i>	I'm waiting for a delivery. (Wolt driver on the phone — this is it)
אני בכניסה.	<i>A-NI ba-kni-SA.</i>	I'm at the entrance. (second call from the driver — use this)
תתקשר אליי.	<i>Tit-ka-SHER e-LAI.</i>	Call me. (simple, direct, works)
אני אבוד/ה.	<i>A-NI a-VUD / a-vu-DA.</i>	I'm lost. (better to admit it than wander for 40 minutes)
יש פה וויפי?	<i>Yesh po WI-FI?</i>	Is there WiFi here? (crosses all cultural barriers)
דחוף.	<i>Da-CHUF.</i>	Urgent. (one word — opens doors and skips queues)
תודה, הצלת אותי.	<i>To-DA, hi-TZAL-ta o-TI.</i>	Thank you, you saved me. (the best thing you can say to any Israeli who helped)

**Now you have the words.
But do you have the reflex?**

Knowing 50 phrases on paper is great. But the Israeli street moves fast. When someone speaks back to you at lightning speed, you need more than a cheat sheet. You need muscle memory.

The 40-Day Hebrew Sprint



Daily 2-minute audio bites

Straight to your phone. Listen on the bus, in line, while you stir coffee.



Zero grammar. 100% action.

Built for the street, not the classroom. Memorize, repeat, deploy.



Real-world challenges

Voice-message tasks that force you to speak and think in Hebrew.

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Questions? Reply directly — we respond within 24 hours.